

STRONG SCALING

The number of processors is increased while the problem size remains constant. Results in a reduced workload per processor. Mostly used for long running CPU bound applications.

Amdahls Law: The speedup is limited by the fraction of the serial part of the software that is not amenable to parallelization. Sweet spot needs to be found. It is reasonable to use small amounts of resources for small problems and larger quantities of resources for big problems.

T = total time, p = part of the program that can be parallelized,, N = amount of processors

$$T = (1 - p)T + T_p = T_s + T_p$$

$$T_N = T_p/N + (1 - p)T_s, \text{Speedup} \leq 1/(s + p/N), \text{Efficiency} = T/(N \cdot T_N)$$

Amdahls law ignores the parallel overhead. Because of that, it is the upper limit of speedup for a problem of fixed size. This seems to be a bottleneck for parallel computing.

Examples: 90% of the computation can run parallel, what is the max speedup with 8 processors?

$$1/(0.1 + 0.9/8) \approx 4.7$$

25% of the computation must be serial. What is the max speedup with ∞ Processors?

$$1/(0.25 + 0.75/\infty) \approx 1/0.25 = 4$$

To gain $500 \times$ speedup on 1000 processors, Amdahls law requires that the proportion of serial part cannot exceed what?

$$500 = 1/(s + \frac{1-p}{1000}) \Rightarrow s + \frac{1-p}{1000} = \frac{1}{500} \Rightarrow 1000s + (1 - s) = 2 \Rightarrow 999s = 1 \Rightarrow s = \frac{1}{999} \approx 0.1\%$$

WEAK SCALING

The number of processors and the problem size is increased. Mostly used for large memory-bound applications where the required memory cannot be satisfied by a single node.

Gustafson's law: Based on the approximations that the parallel part scales linearly with the amount of resources, and that the serial part does not increase with respect to the size of the problem. $\text{Speedup} = s + p \cdot N = s + (1 - s) \cdot N$

In this case, the problem size assigned to each processing element stays constant and additional elements are used to solve a larger total problem. Therefore, this type of measurement is justification for programs that take a lot of memory or other system resources.

Example: 64 Processors. 5% of the program is serial, What is the scaled weak speedup?

$$0.05 + 0.95 \cdot 64 = 60.85$$